

PROTECTING HONEST OFFICIALS AND VIGILANCE ADMINISTRATION

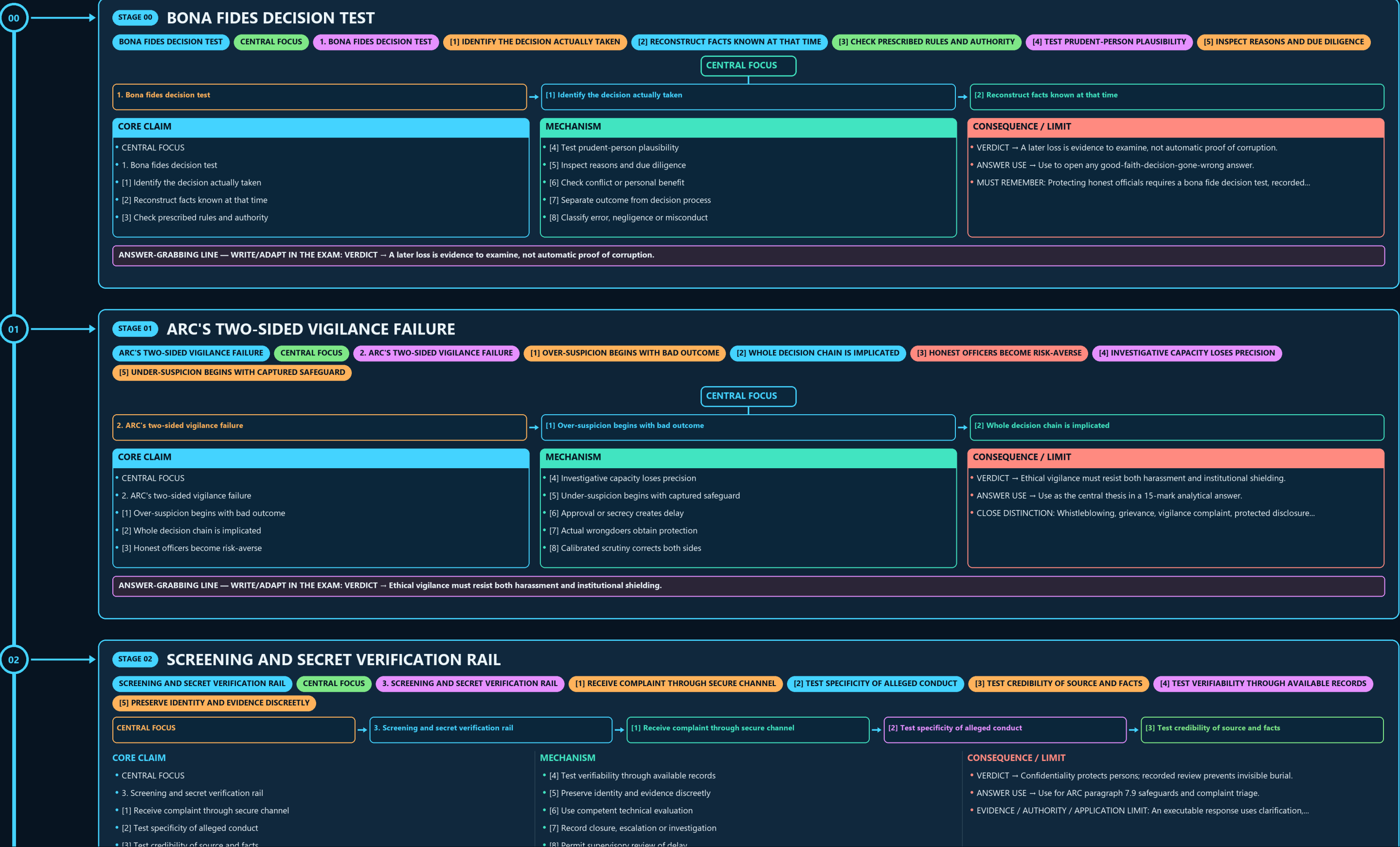
BONA FIDES DECISION TEST → ARC'S TWO-SIDED VIGILANCE FAILURE → SCREENING AND SECRET VERIFICATION → SECTION 17A AND SECTION → FROM SINGLE DIRECTIVE TO → ACCOUNTABILITY OF INVESTIGATORS

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

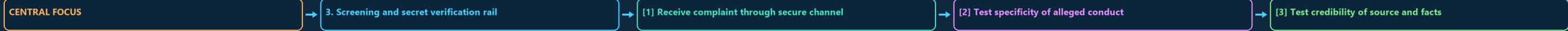
CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



02

STAGE 02 SCREENING AND SECRET VERIFICATION RAIL

SCREENING AND SECRET VERIFICATION RAIL CENTRAL FOCUS 3. SCREENING AND SECRET VERIFICATION RAIL [1] RECEIVE COMPLAINT THROUGH SECURE CHANNEL [2] TEST SPECIFICITY OF ALLEGED CONDUCT [3] TEST CREDIBILITY OF SOURCE AND FACTS [4] TEST VERIFIABILITY THROUGH AVAILABLE RECORDS [5] PRESERVE IDENTITY AND EVIDENCE DISCREETLY



CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 3. Screening and secret verification rail
- [1] Receive complaint through secure channel
- [2] Test specificity of alleged conduct
- [3] Test credibility of source and facts

MECHANISM

- [4] Test verifiability through available records
- [5] Preserve identity and evidence discreetly
- [6] Use competent technical evaluation
- [7] Record closure, escalation or investigation
- [8] Permit supervisory review of delay

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- VERDICT → Confidentiality protects persons; recorded review prevents invisible burial.
- ANSWER USE → Use for ARC paragraph 7.9 safeguards and complaint triage.
- EVIDENCE / AUTHORITY / APPLICATION LIMIT: An executable response uses clarification,...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Confidentiality protects persons; recorded review prevents invisible burial.

03

STAGE 03 SECTION 17A AND SECTION 19

SECTION 17A AND SECTION 19 CENTRAL FOCUS 4. SECTION 17A AND SECTION 19 [1] 17A GATE PRE-ENQUIRY OR INVESTIGATION [2] 17A NEXUS OFFICIAL RECOMMENDATION OR DECISION [3] 17A EXCEPTION

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CENTRAL FOCUS	[3] 17A exception: on-the-spot undue advantage	[7] Both require timely competent decision
4. Section 17A and Section 19	[4] 17A risk: inquiry blocked too early	[8] Neither converts sanction into acquittal
[1] 17A gate: pre-enquiry or investigation	[5] 19 gate: court takes cognizance	VERDICT → The provisions protect at different stages and must never be collapsed.
[2] 17A nexus: official recommendation or decision	[6] 19 scope: specified corruption offences	ANSWER USE → Use for a legal-ethical distinction in GS-IV or GS-II overlap.

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 4. Section 17A and Section 19
- [1] 17A gate: pre-enquiry or investigation
- [2] 17A nexus: official recommendation or decision

MECHANISM

- [3] 17A exception: on-the-spot undue advantage
- [4] 17A risk: inquiry blocked too early
- [5] 19 gate: court takes cognizance
- [6] 19 scope: specified corruption offences

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Both require timely competent decision
- [8] Neither converts sanction into acquittal
- VERDICT → The provisions protect at different stages and must never be collapsed.
- ANSWER USE → Use for a legal-ethical distinction in GS-IV or GS-II overlap.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → The provisions protect at different stages and must never be collapsed.

04

STAGE 04 FROM SINGLE DIRECTIVE TO CURRENT UNCERTAINTY

FROM SINGLE DIRECTIVE TO CURRENT UNCERTAINTY CENTRAL FOCUS 5. FROM SINGLE DIRECTIVE TO CURRENT UNCERTAINTY [1] EXECUTIVE SINGLE DIRECTIVE PROTECTED SENIOR RANKS [2] VINEET NARAIN ANNULLED EXECUTIVE PROTECTION [3] CVC ACT INSERTED DSPE ACT 6A



CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 5. From single directive to current uncertainty
- [1] Executive single directive protected senior ranks
- [2] Vineet Narain annulled executive protection

MECHANISM

- [3] CVC Act inserted DSPE Act 6A
- [4] Subramanian Swamy struck 6A in 2014
- [5] PC Amendment inserted 17A in 2018
- [6] 17A shifted from rank to conduct nexus

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

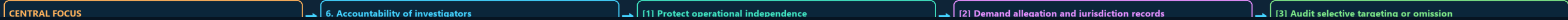
- [7] Supreme Court split on 13 January 2026
- [8] Official order referred matter for new Bench
- VERDICT → The old rank rule is gone; Section 17A's final constitutional status remains contested.
- ANSWER USE → Use for chronology and current-anchor accuracy.

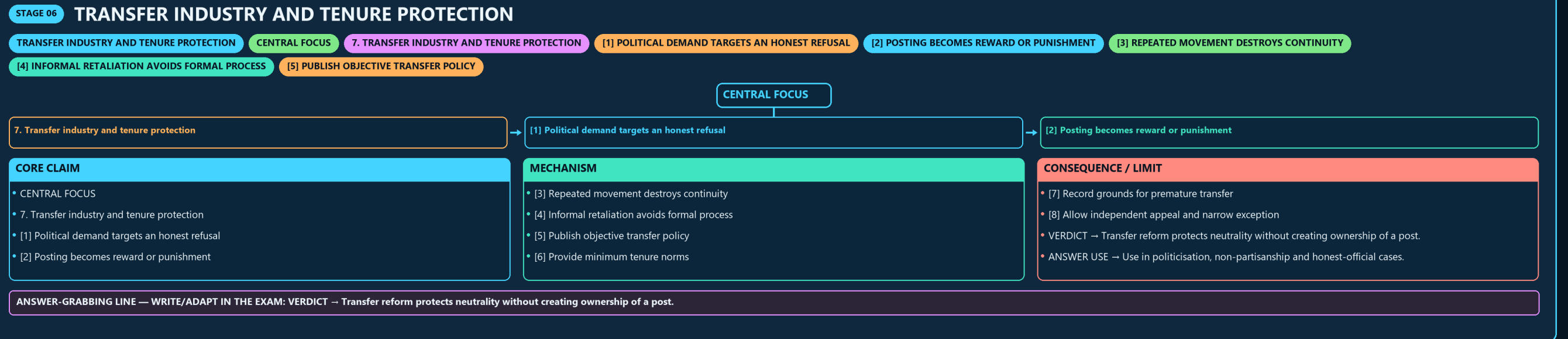
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → The old rank rule is gone; Section 17A's final constitutional status remains contested.

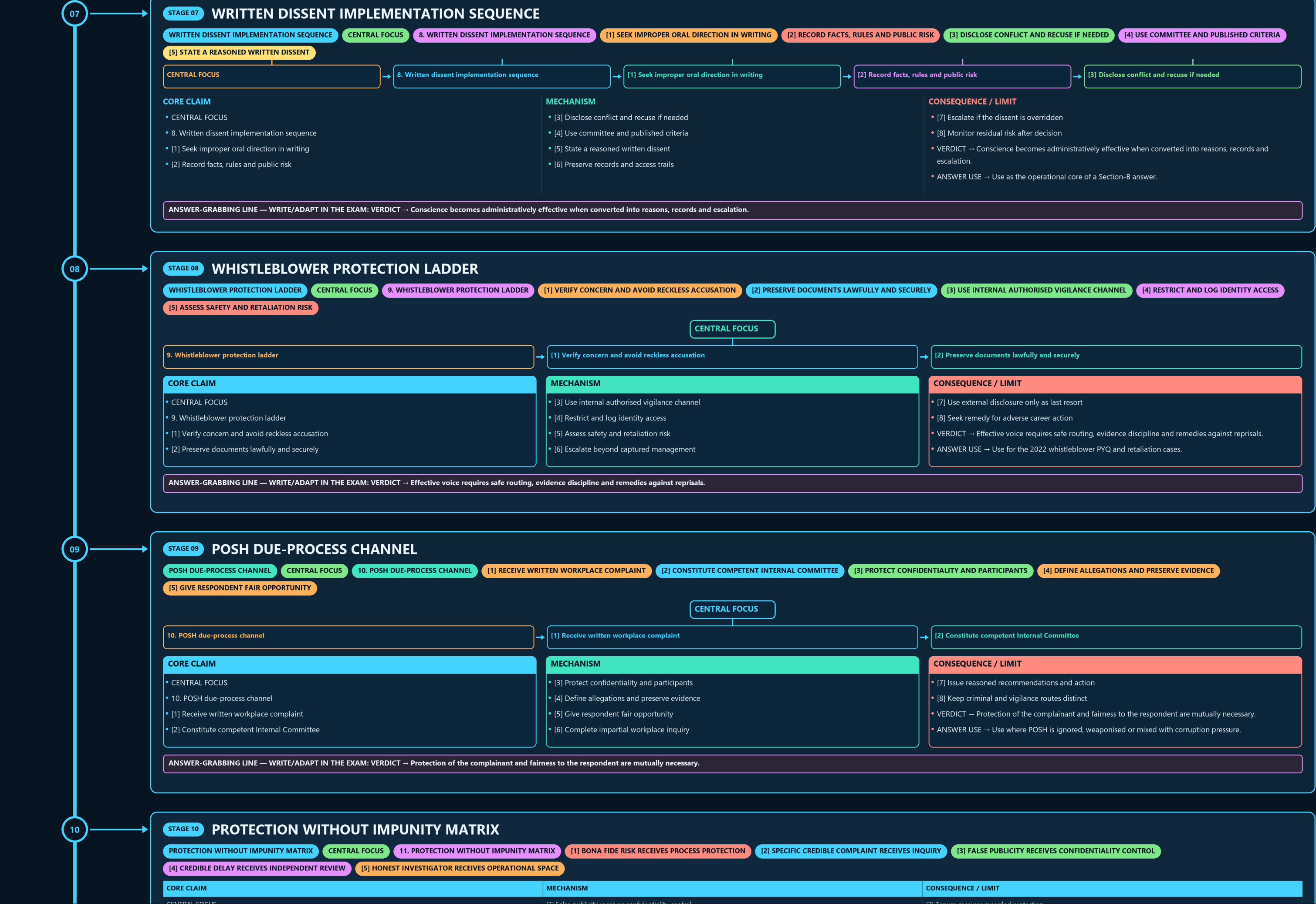
05

STAGE 05 ACCOUNTABILITY OF INVESTIGATORS

ACCOUNTABILITY OF INVESTIGATORS CENTRAL FOCUS 6. ACCOUNTABILITY OF INVESTIGATORS [1] PROTECT OPERATIONAL INDEPENDENCE [2] DEMAND ALLEGATION AND JURISDICTION RECORDS [3] AUDIT SELECTIVE TARGETING OR OMISSION [4] TEST FABRICATED OR SUPPRESSED EVIDENCE [5] REVIEW COERCIVE DELAY AND PUBLICITY







- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 10. POSH due-process channel
- [1] Receive written workplace complaint
- [2] Constitute competent Internal Committee

- [3] Protect confidentiality and participants
- [4] Define allegations and preserve evidence
- [5] Give respondent fair opportunity
- [6] Complete impartial workplace inquiry

- [7] Issue reasoned recommendations and action
- [8] Keep criminal and vigilance routes distinct
- VERDICT → Protection of the complainant and fairness to the respondent are mutually necessary.
- ANSWER USE → Use where POSH is ignored, weaponised or mixed with corruption pressure.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Protection of the complainant and fairness to the respondent are mutually necessary.

10

STAGE 10

PROTECTION WITHOUT IMPUNITY MATRIX

PROTECTION WITHOUT IMPUNITY MATRIX

CENTRAL FOCUS

11. PROTECTION WITHOUT IMPUNITY MATRIX

[1] BONA FIDE RISK RECEIVES PROCESS PROTECTION

[2] SPECIFIC CREDIBLE COMPLAINT RECEIVES INQUIRY

[3] FALSE PUBLICITY RECEIVES CONFIDENTIALITY CONTROL

[4] CREDIBLE DELAY RECEIVES INDEPENDENT REVIEW

[5] HONEST INVESTIGATOR RECEIVES OPERATIONAL SPACE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CENTRAL FOCUS	[3] False publicity receives confidentiality control	[7] Tenure receives recorded protection
11. Protection without impunity matrix	[4] Credible delay receives independent review	[8] Proved misconduct receives lawful consequence
[1] Bona fide risk receives process protection	[5] Honest investigator receives operational space	VERDICT → Every safeguard must protect integrity while preserving a path to verified accountability.
[2] Specific credible complaint receives inquiry	[6] Abusive investigator receives accountability	ANSWER USE → Use as a balanced conclusion rather than a one-sided immunity claim.

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 11. Protection without impunity matrix
- [1] Bona fide risk receives process protection
- [2] Specific credible complaint receives inquiry

MECHANISM

- [3] False publicity receives confidentiality control
- [4] Credible delay receives independent review
- [5] Honest investigator receives operational space
- [6] Abusive investigator receives accountability

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Tenure receives recorded protection
- [8] Proved misconduct receives lawful consequence
- VERDICT → Every safeguard must protect integrity while preserving a path to verified accountability.
- ANSWER USE → Use as a balanced conclusion rather than a one-sided immunity claim.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT → Every safeguard must protect integrity while preserving a path to verified accountability.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANSWER USE → Use as a balanced conclusion rather than a one-sided immunity claim.

11

STAGE 11

EXAMINER-READY ANSWER SPINE

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CENTRAL FOCUS

12. EXAMINER-READY ANSWER SPINE

[1] NAME THE COMPETING PUBLIC VALUES

[2] IDENTIFY OVER-SUSPICION OR SHIELDING RISK

[3] APPLY THE BONA FIDES PROCESS TEST

[4] ADD SCREENING AND VERIFICATION SAFEGUARDS

[5] SEPARATE 17A, 19 AND ADJUDICATION STAGES

CENTRAL FOCUS

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12. Examiner-ready answer spine

→

[1] Name the competing public values

→

[2] Identify over-suspicion or shielding risk

→

[3] Apply the bona fides process test

CORE CLAIM - CENTRAL FOCUS 12. Examiner-ready answer spine [1] Name the competing public values [2] Identify over-suspicion or shielding risk	MECHANISM [3] Apply the bona fides process test [4] Add screening and verification safeguards [5] Separate 17A, 19 and adjudication stages [6] Add dissent, transfer and reporting remedies	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT [7] Protect parallel POSH due process [8] Conclude with protection without impunity - VERDICT → A high-quality answer joins ethical principle, named institution, action and qualification. - ANSWER USE → Use to structure 10-, 15- and 20-mark responses.
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → A high-quality answer joins ethical principle, named institution, action and qualification.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

1. ARCHITECTURE

2. CONCEPTS AND DISTINCTIONS

3. DETAILED TREATMENT

4. INSTITUTIONAL AND REFORM ARCHITECTURE

5. INDIAN APPLICATIONS AND BOUNDARY CASES

6. LIMITATIONS AND TRADE-OFFS

7. MUST-KNOW FACTS FOR ADVANCED PRELIMS

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH 1. Architecture 2. Concepts and distinctions 3. Detailed treatment 4. Institutional and reform architecture	ADVANCED DEBATE 5. Indian applications and boundary cases 6. Limitations and trade-offs 7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims 8. Advanced Prelims traps	LEGACY / NUANCE 9. Current-anchor application 10. PYQ-based analytical application 11. Mains-ready framework 12. Probable questions
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OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.